

INDIA TODAY

www.indiatoday.com

Editor-in-Chief: Aroon Purie

Chief Executive Officer: Ashish Bagga

Editor: Prabhu Chawla

Managing Editors: Raj Chengappa, Dilip Bobb, Shankar Aiyar

Editor-at-Large: S. Prasannarajan, Executive Editor: Kaveree Bamzai

Deputy Editors: Farzand Ahmed, Damayanti Datta,

Ashok K. Damodaran, Sharda Ugra

Senior Editors: Saurabh Shukla, MUMBAI: Malini Bhupta,

HYDERABAD: Amarnath K. Menon

Photo Editor: Bandep Singh

Art Editor: Sapna Kapoor

Associate Editors: S. Sahaya Ranjit, Priya Sahgal, Sandeep Unnithan,

AHMEDABAD: Uday Mahurkar, CHANDIGARH: Ramesh Vinayak,

LUCKNOW: Subhash Mishra

Assistant Editors: Nivedita Mukherjee,

THIRUVANANTHAPURAM: M.G. Radhakrishnan, KOLKATA: Elora Sen

Special Correspondents: Shafi Rahman, JAIPUR: Rohit Parihar,

BANGALORE: Nirmala Ravindran

Principal Correspondents: Mihir Srivastava, Nandini Vaish,

BANGALORE: Stephen David, Swagata Sen; BHOPAL: Ambresh Mishra,

MUMBAI: Aditi Pai, PATNA: Amitabh Srivastava

Copy Desk: Shalini S. Sharma (Assistant Editor), Kaushik Deka, Rahul Kumar,

Sangram Keshari Parhi, Shijith P.K., Shilpi, Priyanka Sood,

Shveta Srivastava, Rahul Tewari, Priya Verma, Anju Yadav

Photo Department: Hemant Chawla, Sipra Das, Yasbanti Negi,

Ravi Sahani, Vikram Sharma, Reuben Singh,

AHMEDABAD: Shailesh Raval, CHENNAI: H.K. Rajashekar,

MUMBAI: Mandar Deodhar, Shriya Patil, Bhaskar Paul,

Rashmi Hajela (Chief Photo Researcher)

Infographics and Illustrations: Saurabh Singh

Art Department: Madhu Bhaskar (Art Director), Ranjita Bhattacharji,

Vandana Nayar, Jyoti K. Singh (Deputy Art Directors), Rasshi Ajmanni Girdhar,

Vipin Gupta, Pushvinder Kaur

Production Department: Surinder Hastu (Chief of Production),

Harish Aggarwal, Naveen Gupta

Publishing Director: Malcolm D. Mistry

Associate Publishers: Manoj Sharma (Impact),

Umesh Kumar (Marketing)

IMPACT TEAM

General Managers: Kaustav Chatterjee (East), V. Somasundaram (Chennai),

Preeti Kohli (North), Jitendra Lad (West)

Deputy General Manager: Viswanath C.V. (Bangalore)

Consumer Marketing Services: Poonam Sangha, Senior General Manager

Sales and Operations: Vivek Gaur, Executive Director

D.V.S. Rama Rao, Senior General Manager

Vinod Das, General Manager (Sales)

C.V. Vaidyalingam, Senior General Manager (South)

Rajesh Menon, General Manager (West)

Rajeev Gandhi, Deputy General Manager (East)

S. Sridhar, General Manager (Operations)



Volume XXXIII Number 35; For the week Aug 26-Sep 1, 2008, released on August 25

• Editorial Office Living Media India Ltd. F-14/15, Connaught Place New Delhi 110001; Phones: 23315801-4;

Fax: 23316180; Cable: Livmedia, New Delhi

• Subscriptions: For assistance contact Customer Care India Today Group, A-61, Sector-57, Noida (UP)-201301;

Phones: Toll-free number: 1800 1800 100 (from BSNL/MTNL lines); (95120) 2479900 from Delhi and

Faridabad; (0120) 2479900 from Rest of India (Monday-Friday, 10 a.m.-6 p.m.); Fax: (0120) 4078080;

e-mail: ircare@indiatoday.com; Mumbai: 022-2444423-6, Fax: 24444358 • Sales: Direct all trade enquiries to

General Manager (Sales), Living Media India Limited, 201 Connaught Place, F-14, Middle Circle, Connaught Place,

New Delhi • Regd. Office: K-9 Connaught Circle, New Delhi 110001 • Impact Offices: Trade Centre, 2nd Floor,

Kamala City, Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Panel, Mumbai 400013; Phone: 24983355; Fax: 24982266 • Hamilton

House, 1-A, Connaught Place, New Delhi 110001; Phone: 23352233; Fax: 23327330 • 98-A, Dr. Radhakrishnan Salai,

2nd Floor, Mylapore, Chennai-600 004; Phones: 28478526-41; Telex: 041-6177 Int In; Fax: 28472178; Cable:

Livmedia Chennai • 201-204 Richmond Towers, 2nd Floor, 12, Richmond Road, Bangalore-560025; Phones:

22212448, 22213037, 22218343; Fax: 22218335; Cable: Livmedia, Bangalore • 52, Jawaharlal Nehru Road,

4th Floor, Kolkata-700071; Phones: 22825398; Fax: 22827254; Cable: Livmedia, Kolkata • 6-3-885/7B,

Somajiguda, Hyderabad-500082; Phone: 23401657, 23400479, 23410100, 23402481, 23410982, 23411498;

Fax: 23403484 • 39/1045, Karakkatt Road, Kochi 682016; Phones: 2377057, 2377058 • Fax: 2377059

• 2C, "Suryarath Bldg", 2nd Floor, Behind White House, Panchwadi, Office C.G. Road, Ahmedabad-380006;

Phone: 26560393, 26560929; Fax: 26565293

• Copyright Living Media India Ltd. All rights reserved throughout the world. Reproduction in any manner is

prohibited. Printed and published by Ashish Bagga on behalf of Living Media India Ltd. Printed at Thomson Press

India Ltd., 18-35 Milestone, Delhi Mathura Road, Faridabad-121007, (Haryana);

A-9, Industrial Complex, Maraimalai Nagar, district Kancheepuram-603209, (Tamil Nadu); and

at Plot No. 5-5A, TTC Industrial Area, Thane, Belapur Road, Airoli, Navi Mumbai-400708, (Maharashtra).

Published at K-9, Connaught Circus, New Delhi-110001.

• INDIA TODAY does not take the responsibility for returning unsolicited publication material.

All disputes are subject to the exclusive jurisdiction of competent courts and forums in Delhi/New Delhi only

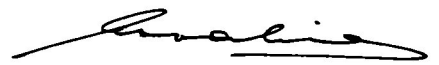
I visited Kashmir three months ago to inaugurate a residential school our charitable foundation, CARE TODAY, had built in collaboration with the Indian Army in a remote area devastated by the 2005 earthquake. We flew from Srinagar by helicopter and I had never seen the Valley look so pristine and peaceful. During my visit, I asked government officials why they didn't publicise the fact that tourists were coming in droves and they said that it would attract terrorists to disrupt the peace. Well, they didn't need the terrorists. Indian politicians were enough.

In just a few weeks, they have turned peaceful Kashmir into a bloody battlefield and a communal tinderbox. The fuse lit by the Amarnath land transfer, its revocation and subsequent demands has snowballed into the most serious crisis that the state has seen since 1993, one with grave national implications. For the Congress-led UPA, it is their worst nightmare. Never before has mistrust and anger between the Hindu-majority Jammu region and Muslim-majority Kashmir Valley run as deep as it does today.

It has also acted as a trigger for lakhs of ordinary people taking to the streets in Kashmir to demand azadi. The internal dynamics have changed so rapidly and with such force that the state can no longer be seen through security paradigms alone. Exactly 60 years ago, Jawaharlal Nehru and Sheikh Abdullah had stood side by side in Srinagar's historic Lal Chowk and recited the Persian couplet *mun tu shudam, tu mun shudi* (I've become you, and you've become me). It was the moment that formalised Jammu and Kashmir's accession to India that Maharaja Hari Singh had signed after the Partition when Pakistan troops had invaded the Valley.

This August 15, thousands of angry protesters reached the very same spot and hoisted the green flags of the separatist Hurriyat Conference along with Pakistani flags. The killing of Sheikh Abdul Aziz, a senior Hurriyat leader, in police firing, created a 'martyr' who has inspired mass defiance and revived Kashmir's separatist movement that had been pushed to the fringes. With the anger in the Valley reaching critical levels, Jammu engulfed in the agitation and the Centre seemingly running out of options, the implications have never been more dangerous. More importantly, the crisis comes at a time when the state faces crucial elections.

For our cover story this issue, we decided to focus on the villains of the peace, so to speak, the politicians, ministers, officials and administrators who have allowed the state to slide into such chaos. Our correspondents in Srinagar and Jammu as well as Delhi have identified the people who are singularly and collectively responsible for creating the crisis which need not have been. Sadly, we have done in Jammu and Kashmir what Pakistan could not do for decades. Obviously, we are our own worst enemy.


(Aroon Purie)